Village Combat - Ravenloft

Lance Denton

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Tile Layouts + Hero Level 3 and 4 Tokens...

Copyright Information

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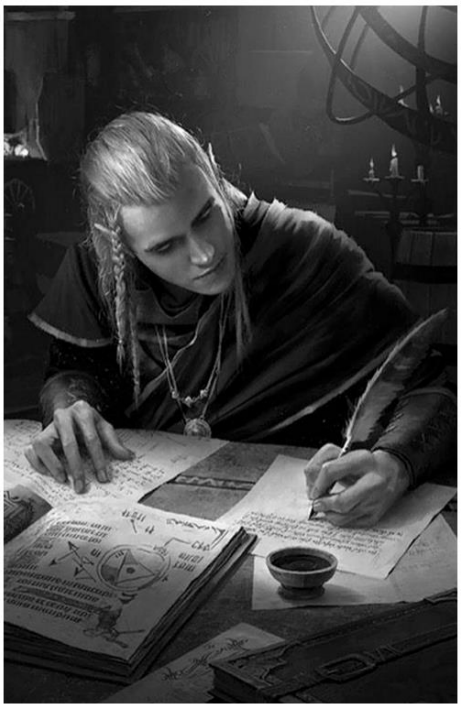
The Adventure Series is an adaptation from "The Wrath of Ashardalon" D&D Adventure Series Board Games owned by Wizards of the Coast (https://dnd.wizards.com/).



Overview

Count Strahd has risen an army of the undead under his command, and unleashed them against a small village in Barovia!

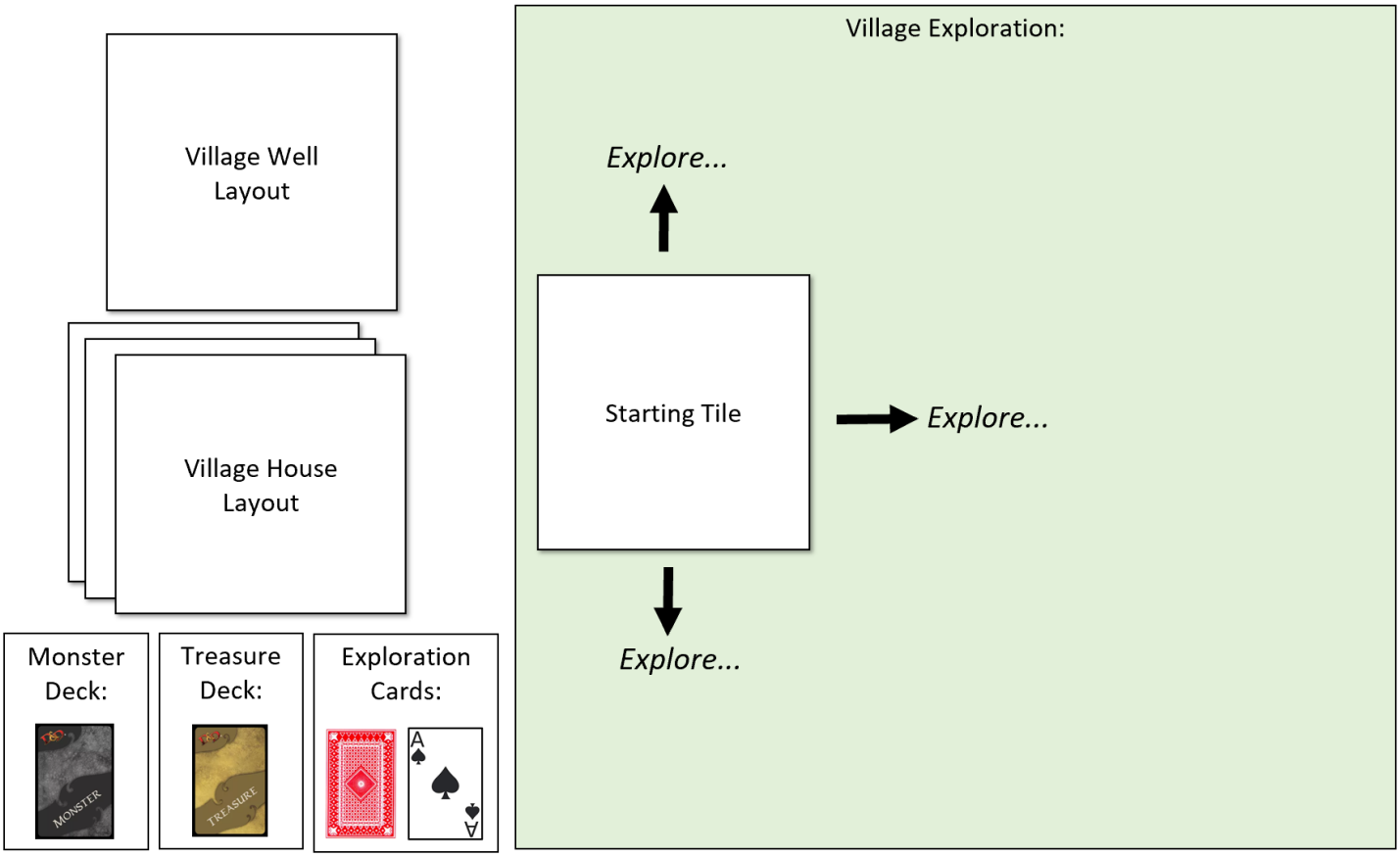
This variant, for **1-5 Players**, uses the **Ravenloft** box set, a deck of **Poker Cards**, 9 **custom 2x2 Tile Layouts**, and a few adjusted rules, to implement a randomly configured Village Combat Episode. *No other box sets or expansions are required*.

Here are some of the distinctive features of this variant:

- **Custom 2x2 Tile Layouts** are used, instead of the interlocking tiles from the box set, including 1 Start Tile, 7 Village House tiles, and 1 Village Well tile.
- A Deck of **Poker Cards** is used to determine which 2x2 tile layout to pull next. If the layout is a **Village House**, the initial Poker card determines what direction to orient it and what Monsters are in the Outside Spaces. Then 2 more cards are placed face-down inside the house to represent further potential Inside Encounters. If the layout is the **Village Well**, then the Poker Card determines which Villain to pull.
- Players still follow Hero-Exploration-Villain Phases, but instead of the out-of-box Encounter Deck and Rules, a **Look-up Table** is used when pulling a new Tile Layout and when entering the inside of a Village House and flipping over the cards that were previously laid face-down.
- **Combat Rewards** are pulled using normal rules.
- Any Inside Encounter can be **canceled/skipped** with 5 XP.
- Heroes may purchase an additional **Surge Token** with 10 XP.

Game Setup

Game Table Layout



Exploration Poker Cards

This variant uses 1 **Poker Card Deck**:
Remove *Jokers* from Poker Card Deck, shuffle all other 52 cards.
These are **Exploration Cards**.

Monster Deck

Shuffle the following Monsters together:

- **Skeleton (x3)**
- **Blazing Skeleton (x3)**
- **Wraith (x3)**
- **Ghoul (x3)**
- **Zombie (x3)**

Set aside the following Villains:

- **Young Vampire**
- **Klak**
- **Howling Hag**

Treasure Deck

This variant uses all **Treasure Cards** from Ravenloft.

Village Tile Layouts

This variant uses 9 custom printed Village Tile Layouts, included at the end of this document. Each layout is a 2x2 tile grid (4 tiles total) and designed for simple black-and-white or color printing at home. Each layout will need to be trimmed of white space so they can be placed together in a grid, as Heroes explore the Village.

- **Layout 1: Starting Tile** = print 1 copy of this layout. Heroes will begin here, and can Explore up, down or to the right.
- **Layout 2: Village House** = print 7 copies of this layout. Then, stack (#Heroes+2) and place to the side (example, 2 Heroes = 4 Village House layouts).
- **Layout 3: Village Well** = print 1 copy of this layout and set to the side. This represents an Outside Villain Encounter, caused by the King Poker Card. (However, it is also possible to run into the Villain inside a Village House before-hand).

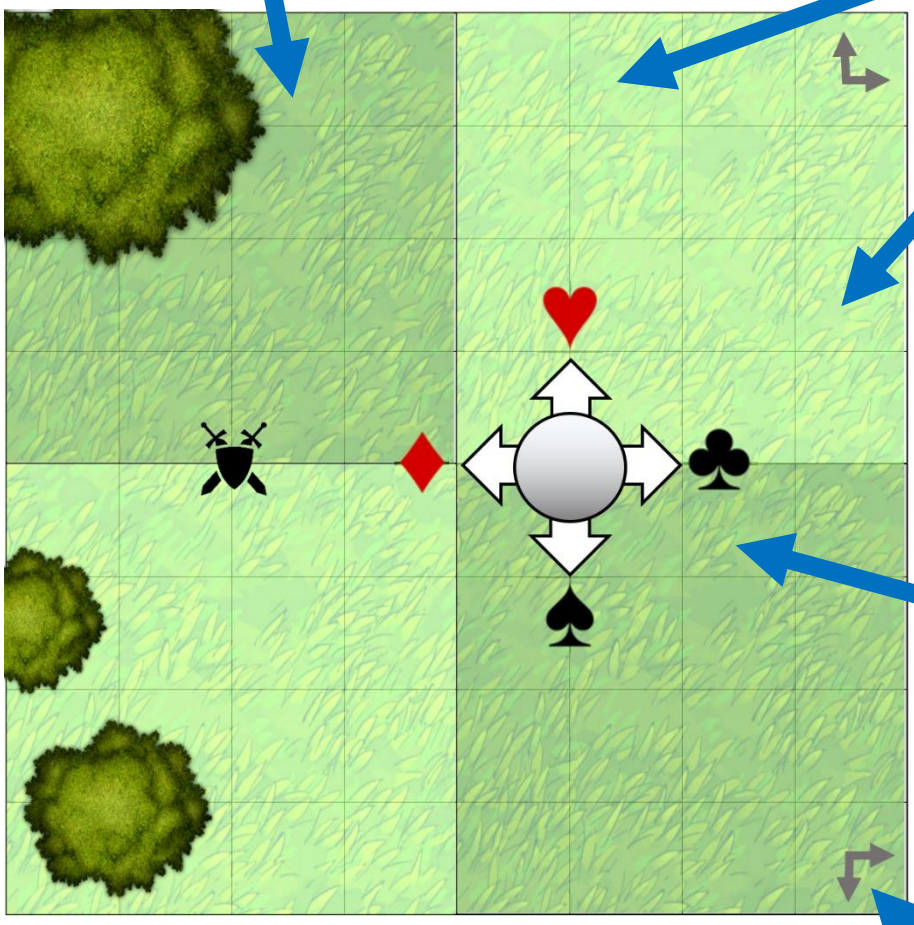
If the size is not correct from printing direct from the PDF, clip each image into a new document and resize to fit your printer and paper, (each map should be about 8in/20cm wide).

Note: the next 3 pages are not designed for printing. See the end of this document for full-sized tiles…

The Starting Tile:

Heroes can start in any space on the left side of the layout, away from an un-explored edge, top or bottom.

If a Hero ends movement on an un-explored edge, begin Outside Exploration Phase and pull the next Card from the Exploration Poker Deck and display it face-up. Then place the corresponding Village House or Village Well layout in line with this one.



This compass determines what orientation/direction to use, when placing a new Village House layout, based on the Suite of the Exploration Poker Card.

If a Hero ends movement on an un-explored corner, Player can choose what edge to explore into…

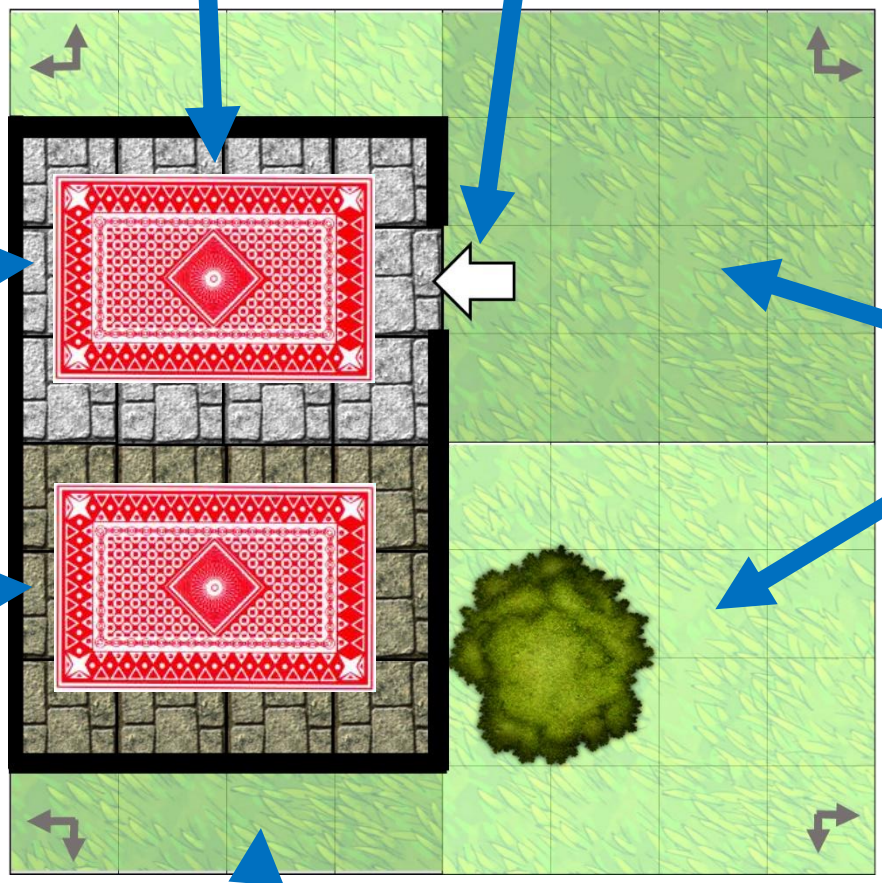
The Village House:

2 additional Exploration Poker Cards are placed face-down inside the House when the layout is put into position.

The white arrow is used to orient the direction of the layout when it is placed on the table, and also to begin the Inside Area "A" Exploration.

This is Inside Area "A".

Hero stops movement on the white arrow to flip over the card, as Exploration Phase begins.



Outside Monsters can be placed anywhere on these spaces, (ignore Sentry Monster instructions for pulling additional tiles).

This is Inside Area "B".

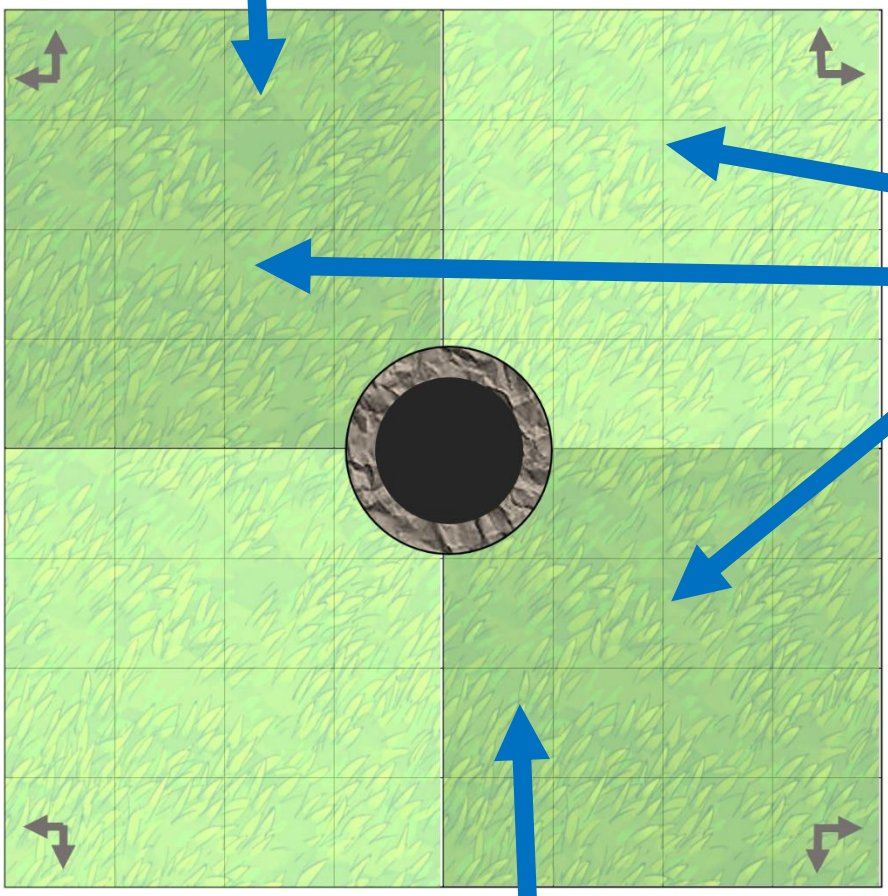
Hero stops movement on the edge of area "A" to flip over the card, as Exploration Phase begins.

The edge of the House is considered "Outside" and does not flip over the card that is "Inside". Instead, it causes a new Outside Exploration Phase and 2x2 tile layout, just like all other un-explored Outside edges.

The Village Well:

This layout is pulled when either a) the Hero has moved to an un-explored Outside edge to start Exploration, and the next Poker Card that is turned face-up is a King, or b) if all other Village House layouts have been pulled and this is the last layout available.

This triggers an Outside Villain Encounter, based on the Suite.



Villain and supporting Monsters can be placed on any space, (ignore Sentry Monster instructions for pulling additional tiles).

If a Villain has already been Encountered inside a Village House, then only the supporting Monsters are placed and activated (1 Villain max per Episode).

Game Play

Tile Layouts and Player Turns

Custom 2x2 Tile Layouts are used instead of the interlocking tiles from the box set, including 1 Start Tile, (#Heroes+2) Village House layouts, and 1 Village Well layout.

Setup Starting Tile on table, place all Heroes in any space on the left side of the layout, top or bottom, avoiding edges. Each of these spaces are “Outside”.

Each Player will follow a traditional Hero-Exploration-Villain Phased turn, with the exception that Encounter Cards and Encounter Rules from the box set are not used. Instead, Exploration Cards from the Poker Deck will determine when Encounters happen.

Begin Hero 1 Phase, end movement on any un-explored edge to begin Outside Exploration. Stopping on a corner allows the Player to choose what direction to expand into.

Image from: https://www.dndbeyond.com

Outside Exploration Phase

When a Hero ends his/her movement on an un-explored Outside edge, begin Outside Exploration Phase.

Pull 1 Poker Card from the Exploration Deck and turn it face-up.

<table>
<tr><th>Card Value</th><th>Tile Layout and Configuration</th></tr>
<tr><td>Ace, 1 – 10, Jack, Queen</td><td>Pull the next Village House Layout. If there are no more available, then follow instructions below for the Village Well Layout.

Place the layout in-line with the previous un-explored edge, and turn the white arrow in the direction that corresponds to the Suite of the Exploration Card:

<table>
<tr><th>Card Suite</th><th>Direction</th></tr>
<tr><td>Hearts</td><td>Up</td></tr>
<tr><td>Clubs</td><td>Right</td></tr>
<tr><td>Spades</td><td>Down</td></tr>
<tr><td>Diamond</td><td>Left</td></tr>
</table>

Next, pull 2 more Poker Cards from the Exploration Deck and place them face-down on each Inside Area of the House, to represent potential Encounters.

Then, based on the Poker Card that was turned face-up, determine if there are any Monsters that occupy the Outside Spaces in front of the House. Each Monster will activate with a different Villain Phase, 1 per Hero.

<table>
<tr><th>Card Value</th><th>Monsters</th></tr>
<tr><td>1-6</td><td>None</td></tr>
<tr><td>7-10, J, Q</td><td>Pull 1 Monster per Hero, place in any Outside Space in front of the Village House.</td></tr>
</table>
</td></tr>
</table>

Continued…

Card Value	*Tile Layout and Configuration*
King	If the **Village Well Layout** has not been pulled, place it level with the previous un-explored edge. If the *Village Well Layout* has already been pulled, ignore the King and pull the next Poker Card from the Exploration Deck. Determine the Monsters that occupy the Outside Spaces around the Well. If a Villain has not been Encountered yet, then setup the Villain + Supporting Monsters. If a Villain has been Encountered already, then pull the Supporting Monsters only (1 Villain per Episode max). Each Supporting Monster activates with a different Villain Phase, 1 per Hero. *Card Suite* — *Monsters* **Hearts** — Howling Hag + 1 Monster per Hero. **Diamonds** — Klak + 1 Monster per Hero. **Spades, Clubs** — Young Vampire + 1 Monster per Hero.

After setting up a *Village House* or *Village Well Layout* and Monsters, begin with current Player's Villain Phase.

Inside Exploration Phase

Each Village House has 2 Inside Areas, A and B.

A is just inside the door, and Exploration begins by ending movement on the white arrow.

B is the darker area inside the house, and Exploration begins by ending movement on an un-explored edge from Area A.

When an Inside Exploration Phase begins, remove the Card from the tile and turn it face-up.

Note: Any Inside Encounter can be **canceled/skipped** with 5 XP.

Card Value	*Encounter*
1-6	Area A: The Doorway was rigged with an arrow trap! Area B: Someone set a trap-door over a Pit! Roll 1d20. Class Bonus: Ranger, Rogue +1. 10+ = you avoided/disarmed the trap. Otherwise: Area A = 1 HP damage + Immobilized Condition, Area B = 2 HP damage + Slowed Condition.
7-10, J, Q	1 Monster per Hero. Each Monster will activate with a different Villain Phase.
King	If a King has already been played, then pull 1 Monster per Hero. Each Monster will activate with a different Villain Phase. Otherwise, pull 1 Villain (alone, with no Supporting Monsters): *Card Suite* — *Villain* Hearts — Howling Hag Diamonds — Klak Spades, Clubs — Young Vampire

If Monsters have been placed on the tiles, begin with current Player's Villain Phase.

Villain Phases, XP

Villain Phases use normal rules, each Monster is activated by the owning Player. Villains activate each turn.

Note: Ranged Attacks must have line-of-sight.

Use home-made XP Chips or keep track of XP on paper, so Monsters can be returned to bottom of Deck. Rules for increasing Hero Level are normal (natural 20 during combat + 5 XP). Hero Level 3 and 4 Tokens are available to print, at the end of the Tile Layouts.

Combat Rewards are pulled using normal rules, if 1 or more Monsters/Villains are defeated during a Hero Phase. Recommended: limit Level 1,2 Heroes to 3 Treasures max, Level 3,4 to 4 Treasures.

Recommended: Heroes may purchase an additional Surge Token with 10 XP.

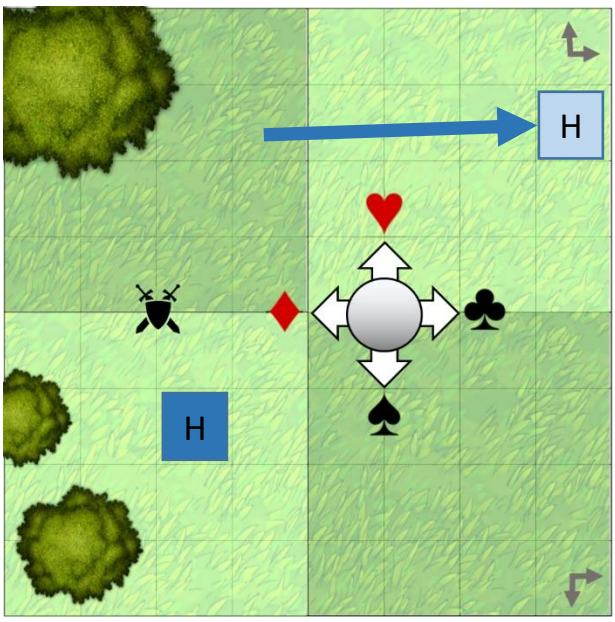
Game Simulation

Example Village Exploration

Below is a simulation of the first 2 Tile Layouts for a Party with 2 Heroes. The Heroes and Monsters are represented with generic markers and the Combat details are not provided…

Example Starting Tile:

First Hero moves to an un-explored Outside edge.



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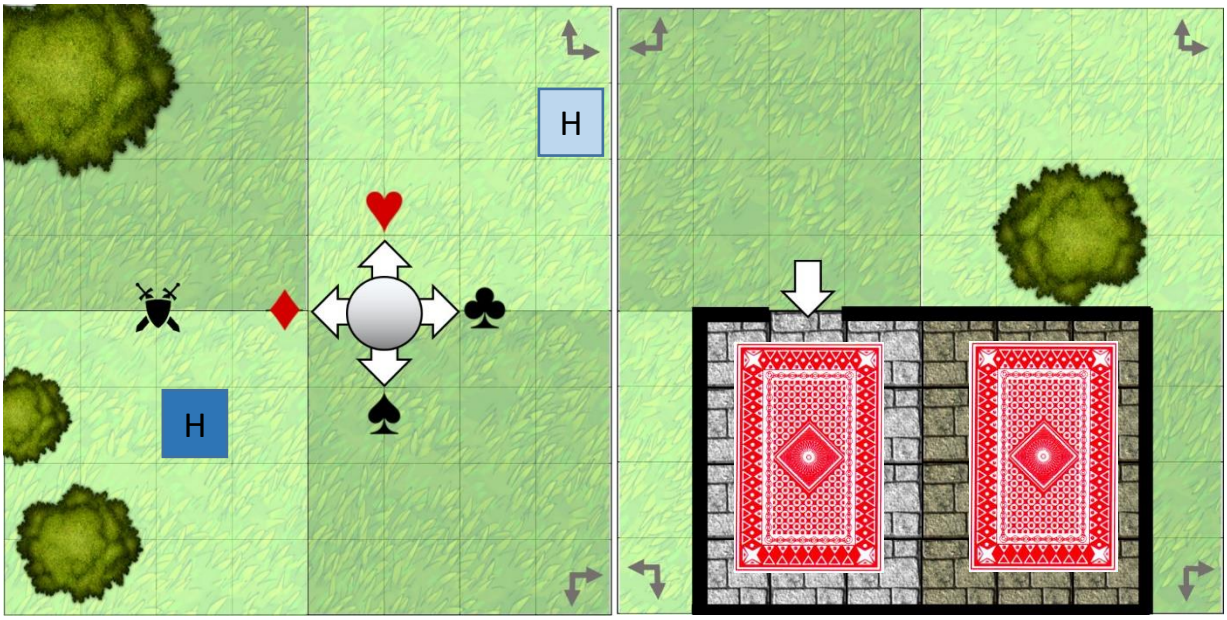
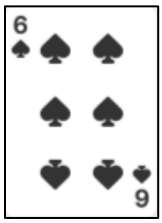
Example Outside Exploration:

1st Exploration Card from Poker Deck is 6 of Spades.

Pull Village House Layout, pointed down, place 2 more Cards face down in House.

No Monsters found Outside.





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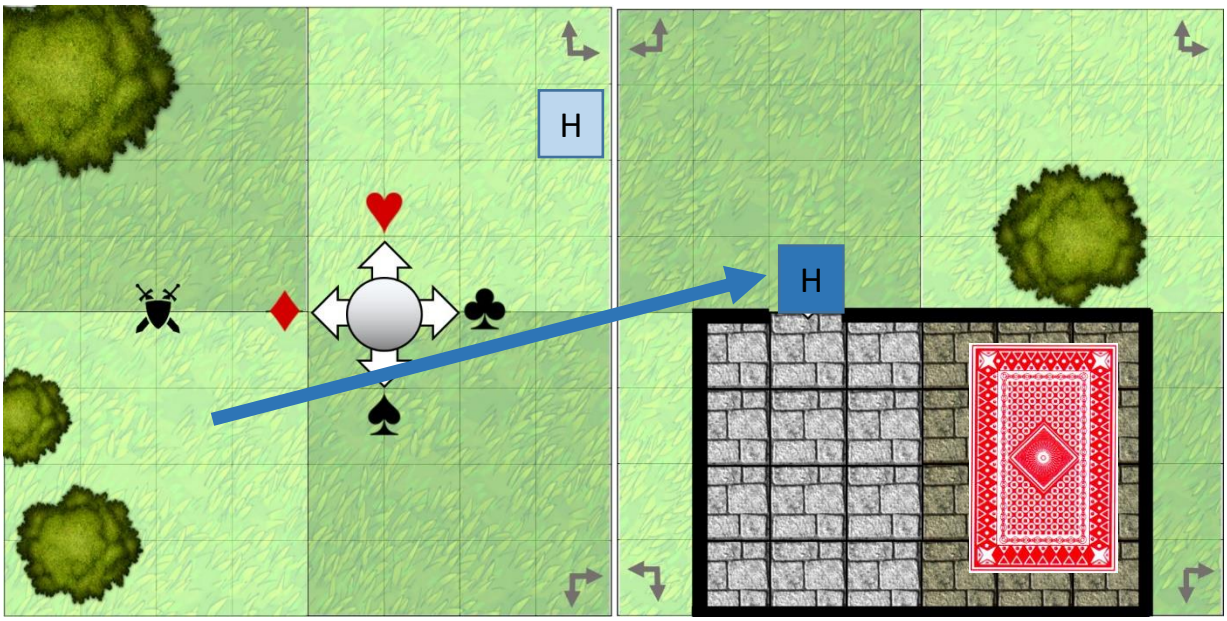
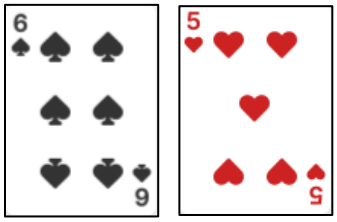
Example Inside Exploration, Area A:

Second Hero moves to Arrow, begins Inside Exploration.

Card is turned over, value is 5 of Hearts = Arrow Trap.

Player rolls 6, takes 1HP damage + Immobilized Condition.





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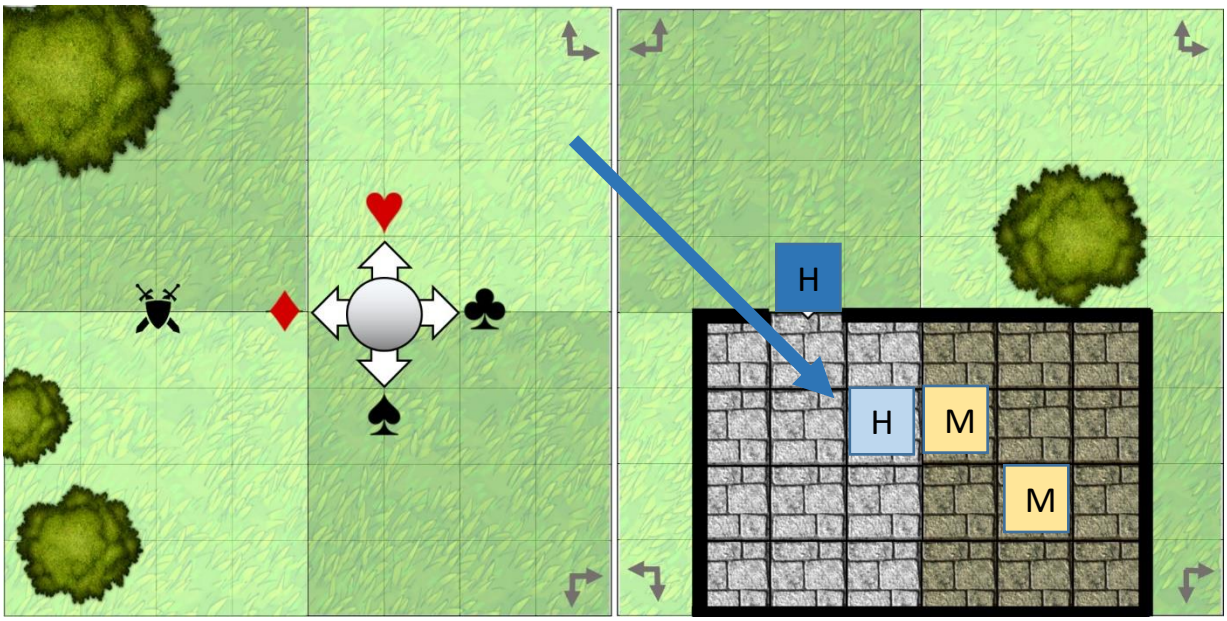
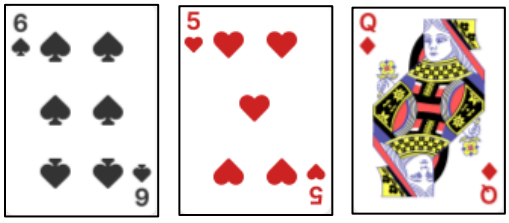
Example Inside Exploration, Area B:

First Hero moves through door and to the edge of Area A, begins Inside Exploration.

Card is turned over, value is Q of Diamonds. Pull 1 Monster per Hero from Deck.

Begin Combat with first Hero Villain Phase.





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Example Outside Exploration:

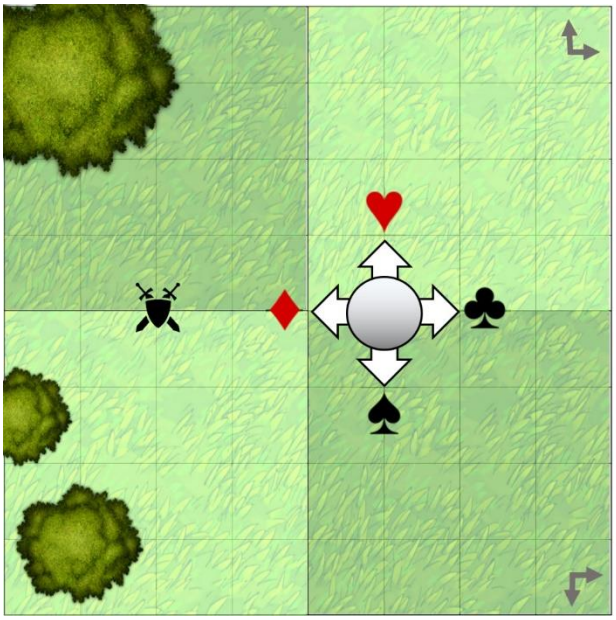
After combat is complete, first hero moves out of House and down to Outside corner edge.

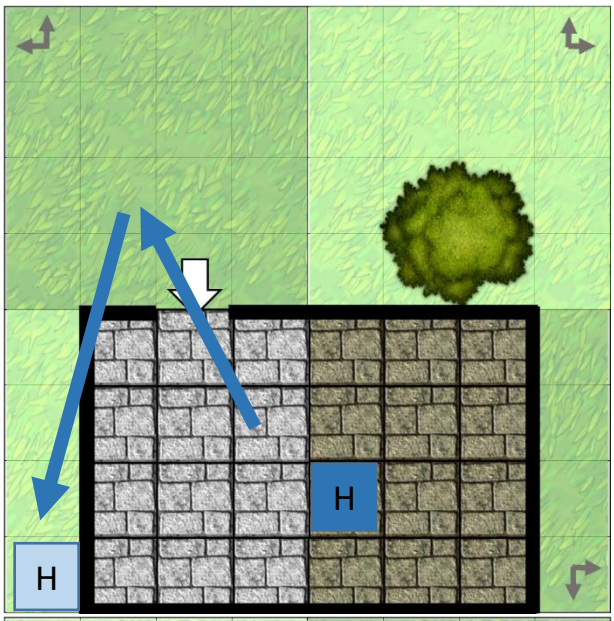
Next Exploration Card from Poker Deck is 8 of Diamonds.

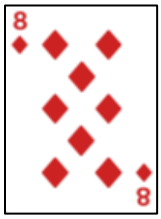
Pull Village House Layout, pointed left, place 2 more Cards face down in House.

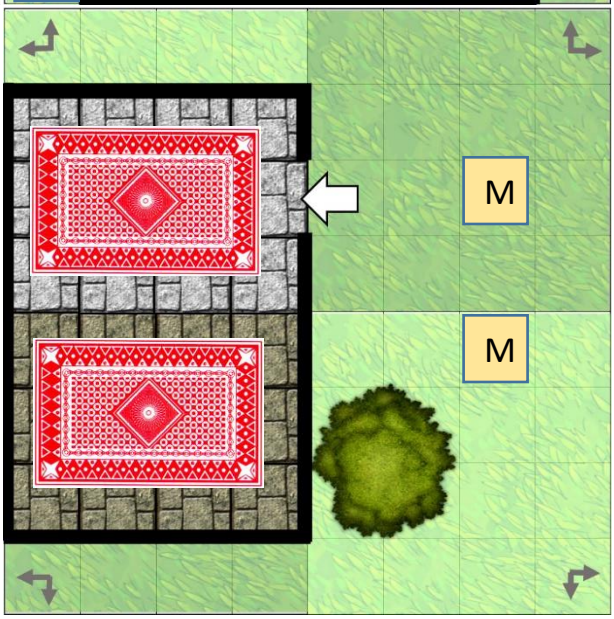
Pull 1 Monster per Hero from Deck, position Outside, in front of House.

Begin Combat with first Hero Villain Phase.



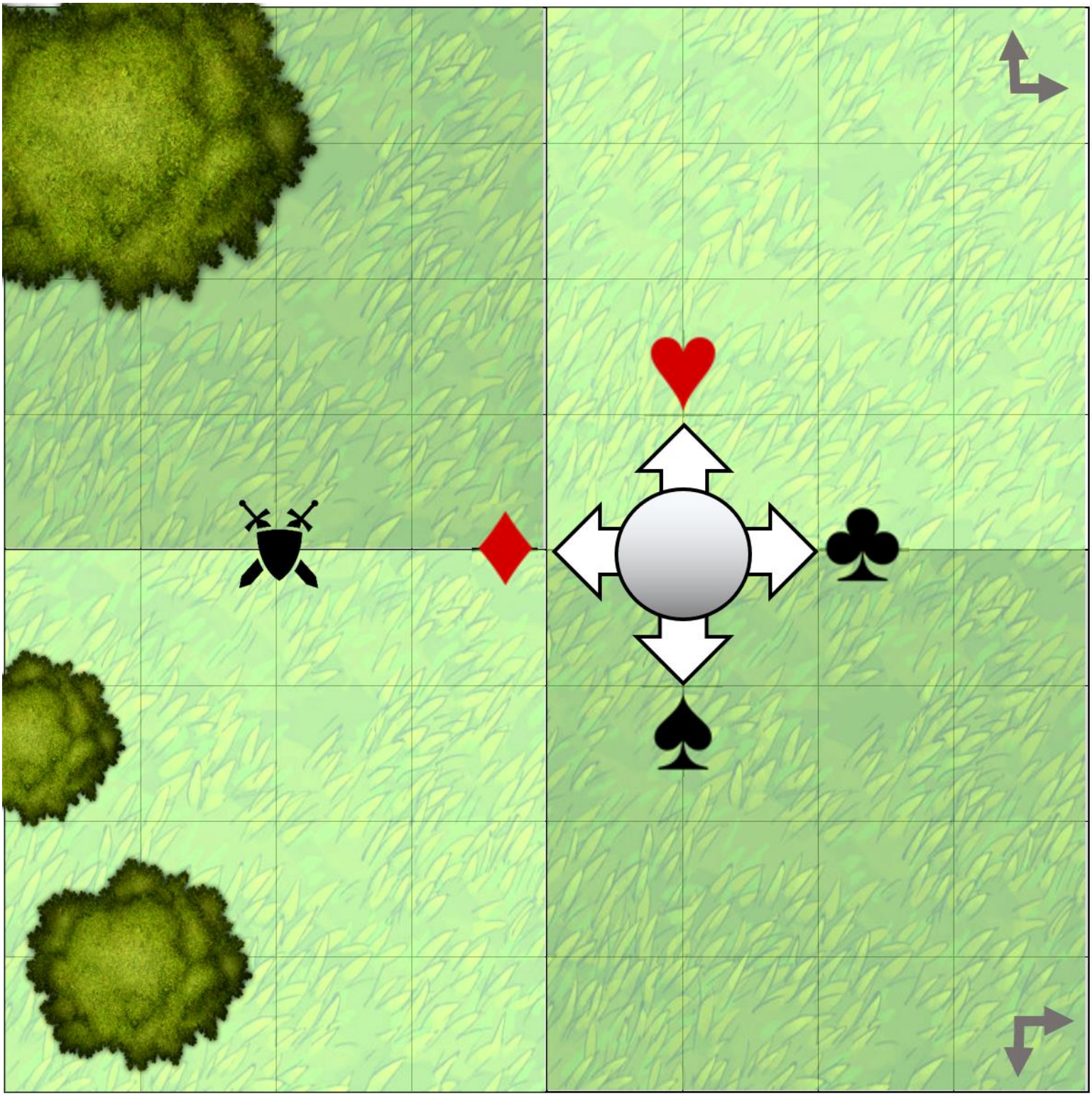






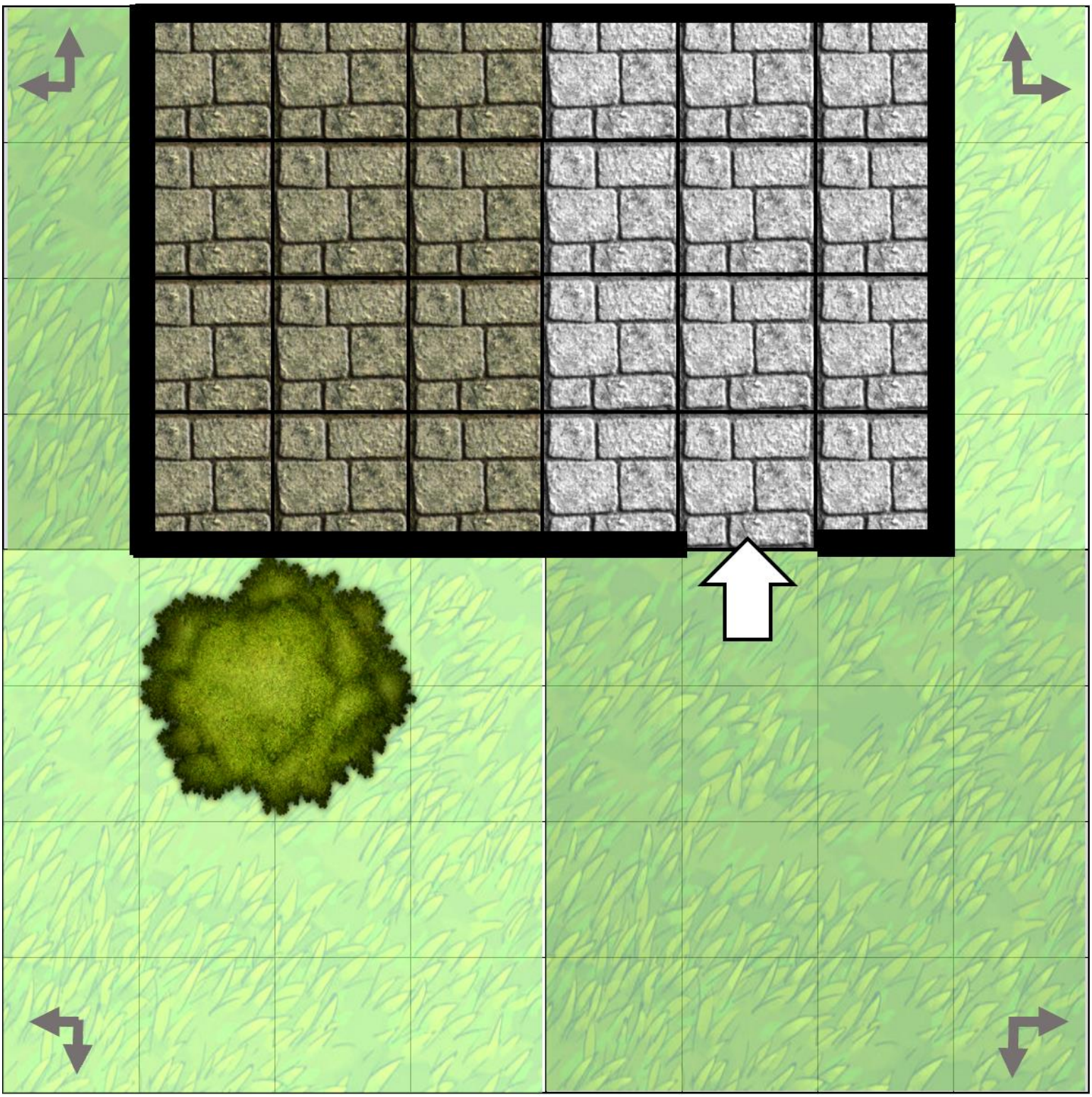
Map 1: Start Tile

Print 1 copy, trim edges…



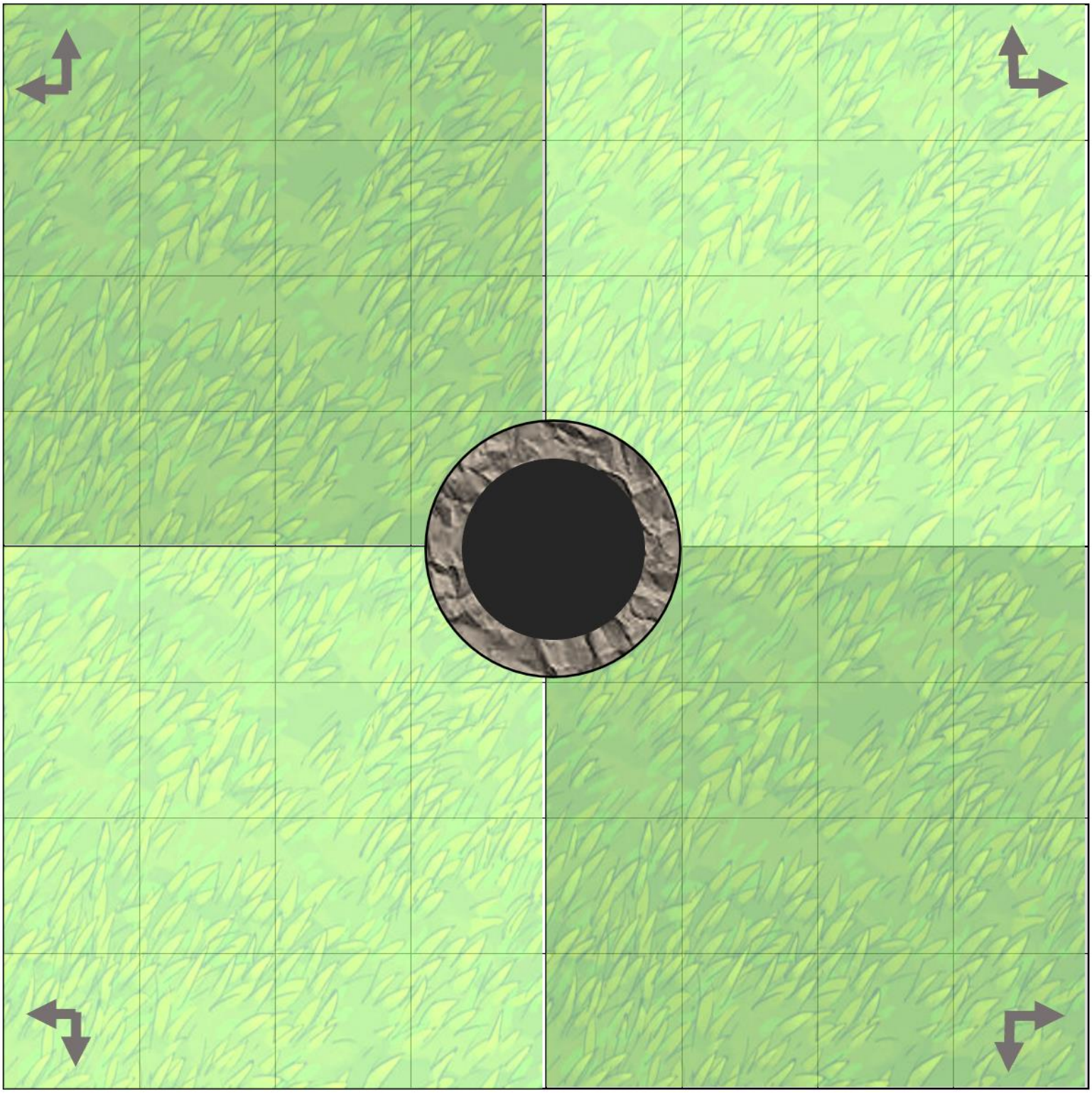
Map 2: Village House Tile

Print 7 copies, trim edges…



Map 3: Village Well Tile

Print 1 copy, trim edges…



Map 1: Start Tile

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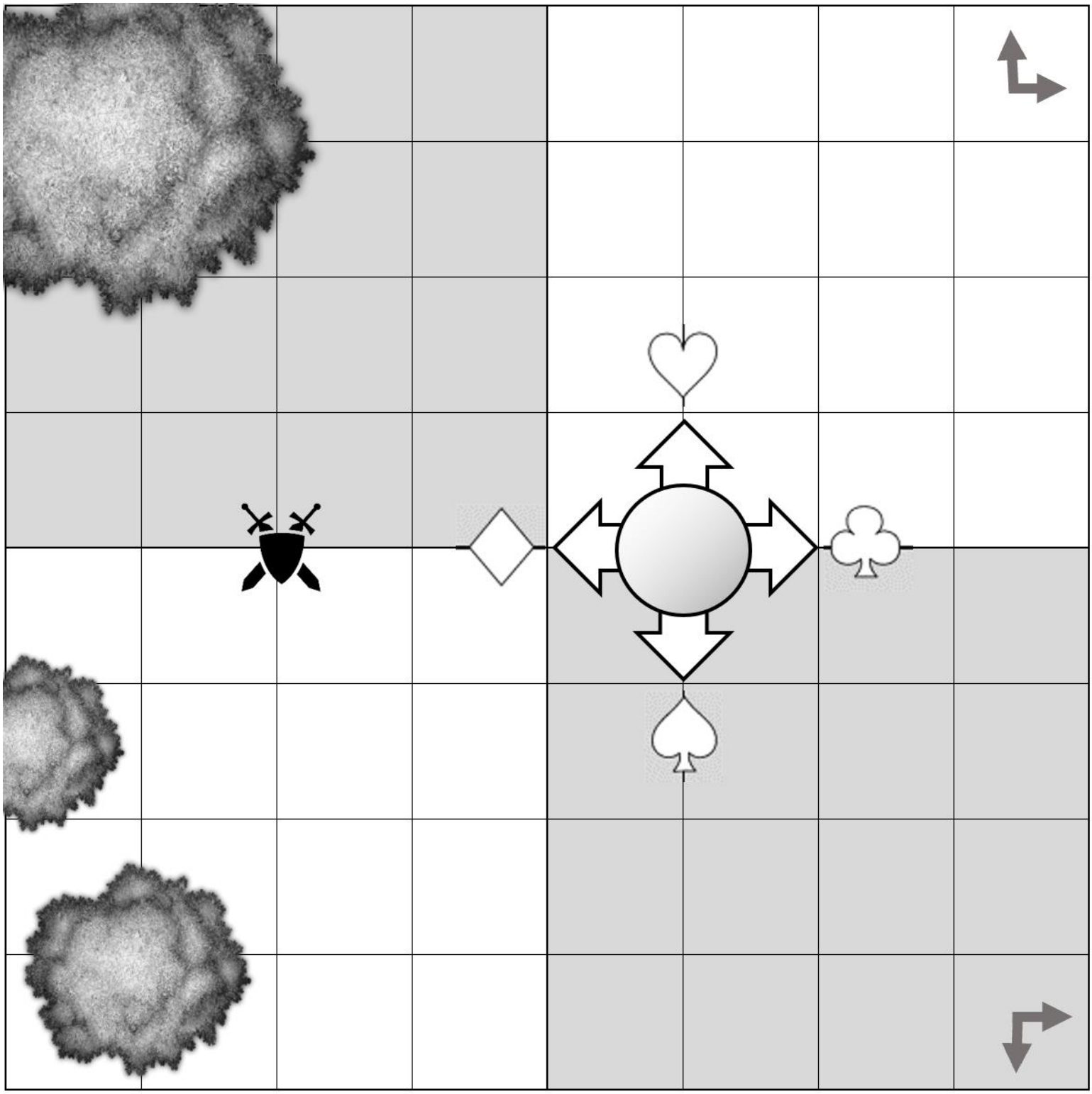

Map 2: Village House Tile

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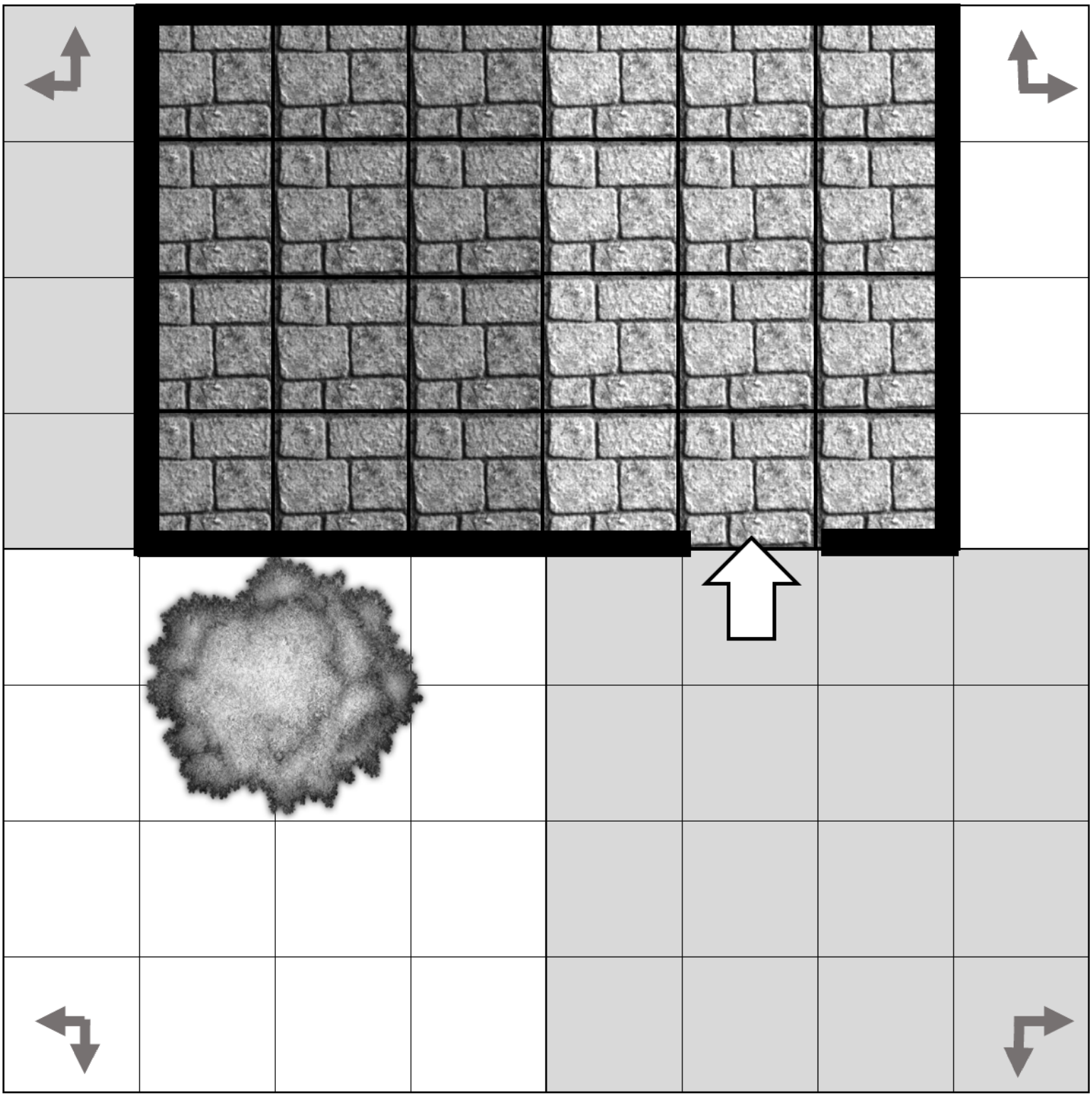
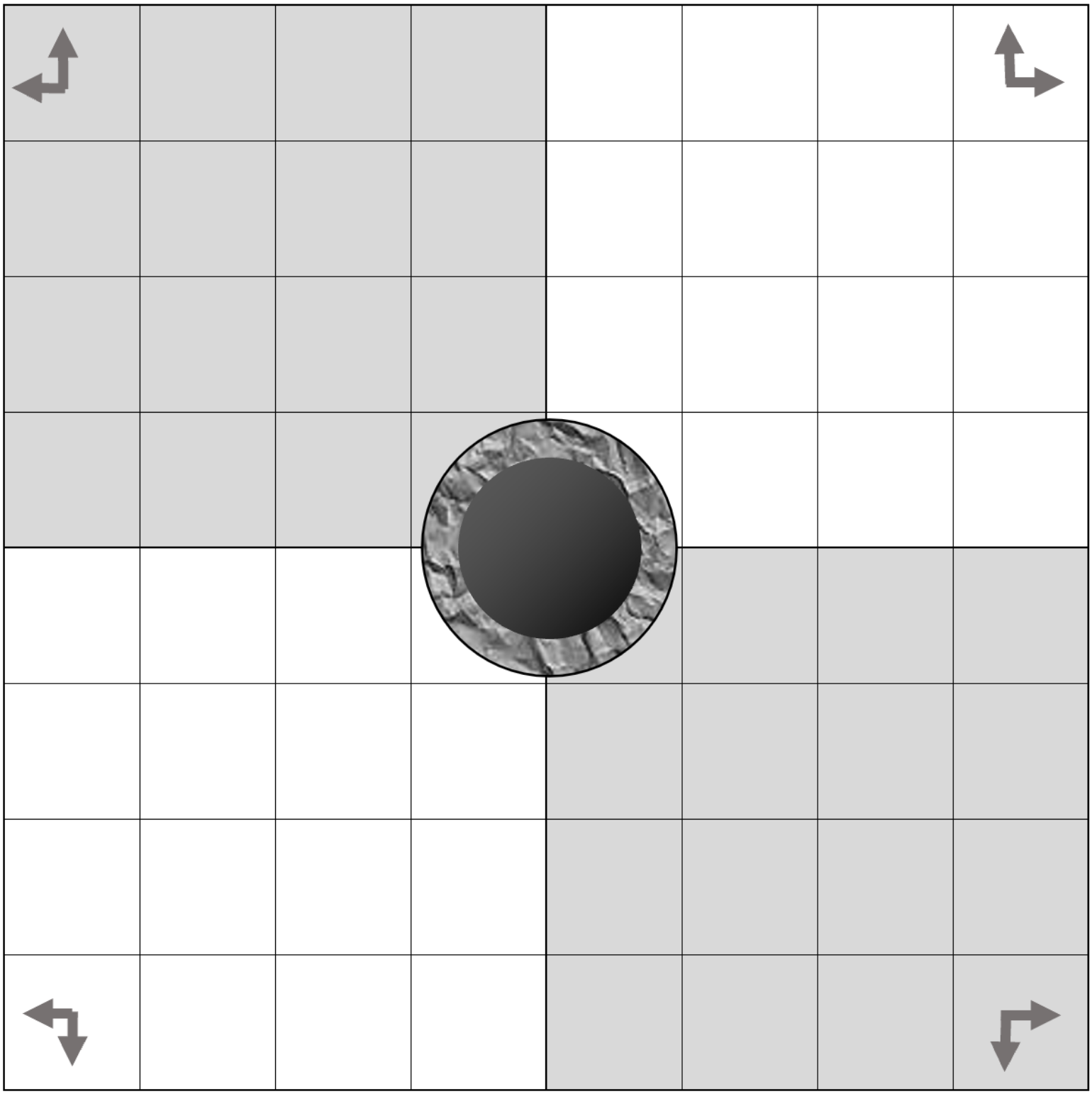


Map 3: Village Well Tile

Print 1 copy, trim edges…



Level: 3		
AC	HP	Surge
+0	+2	+1
+1 Daily/Utility Power Critical Hit: +1 damage and flip 1 Utility/Daily Power		

Level: 4		
AC	HP	Surge
+2	+4	+2
+1 Daily/Utility Power Critical Hit: +2 damage and flip 1 Utility/Daily Power		

Level: 3		
AC	HP	Surge
+0	+2	+1
+1 Daily/Utility Power Critical Hit: +1 damage and flip 1 Utility/Daily Power		

Level: 4		
AC	HP	Surge
+2	+4	+2
+1 Daily/Utility Power Critical Hit: +2 damage and flip 1 Utility/Daily Power		

Level: 3		
AC	HP	Surge
+0	+2	+1
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+2	+4	+2
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Level: 3		
AC	HP	Surge
+0	+2	+1
+1 Daily/Utility Power Critical Hit: +1 damage and flip 1 Utility/Daily Power		

Level: 4		
AC	HP	Surge
+2	+4	+2
+1 Daily/Utility Power Critical Hit: +2 damage and flip 1 Utility/Daily Power		

Level: 3		
AC	HP	Surge
+0	+2	+1
+1 Daily/Utility Power Critical Hit: +1 damage and flip 1 Utility/Daily Power		

Level: 4		
AC	HP	Surge
+2	+4	+2
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